

Principles of Research in Psychology (Lab)

PSYC 2100 · Fall 2026

Time Tuesday 2-3:50pm
Room Herbst (SHH; Oak) 205

Instructor Emma Wing, MS (she/her)
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Drop-in hours Fridays 10-11am & by appointment
via our Microsoft Teams link
Or email me with your availability!



*my research area is
psycholinguistics*

1 Overview

Main objective for this course: Experience the research process by working in a group to develop, conduct, and report on an experiment in psychology.

The final products of this course are a 15-page double-spaced APA-style paper describing your research and a presentation for your classmates. The paper will be broken down into sections (introduction, methods, results, discussion, and abstract), you will submit drafts, and I will revise and provide you with constructive feedback on each assignment which you will use to put together your final research projects.

2 Learning objectives

By the end of this course, you will be able to...

- Formulate a research question on a topic of your (group's) choice
- Conduct a literature search to identify relevant previous studies
- Design a study that tests your research question
- Follow the application process for approval of studies involving human subjects
- Collect data!
- Analyze data using SPSS (statistics software)
- Write and revise an APA-style paper describing your study
- Present your results to the class

Quick Links

Course modality	Attendance & late work
Assignments & grading	Student responsibilities & resources
Note on group work	Course schedule

3 Modality

We will meet synchronously and in person. We will use [Microsoft Teams](#) for all content, communication, and assignments.

4 Assignments & Grading

Your lab grade is worth 40% of your overall course grade.

GRADING BREAKDOWN					
RESEARCH PAPER		OTHER ASSIGNMENTS			
Introduction draft	7 pts	Research ideas	3 pts	SPSS Exercises	3 pts
Methods draft	7 pts	Literature review	5 pts	Presentation	10 pts
Results draft	7 pts	Proposal	7 pts	Mid-semester evaluation	2 pts
Discussion draft	8 pts	IRB forms	5 pts	Final evaluation	2 pts
Final paper	25 pts	CITI training	3 pts	Lab participation	6 pts

Note: Bolded items in the grading breakdown are to be completed [as a group](#).

What is a W Course?

According to UConn policy, you cannot pass a W course unless you receive a passing grade for its written portion. If you fail the written portion of this lab, you automatically fail the lab and the course as a whole, even if your final grade is considered a passing grade.

The written portion of the lab requires submitting 15 double-spaced pages of *revised* writing within the allotted time. The pages contribute toward a final research paper. A draft of each section of the paper is therefore required; these drafts are due and graded well before the final paper is due, allowing for plenty of time to revise before submitting the final paper.

This is a big undertaking! Research projects in psychology are not typically completed and written up so quickly. Given the abbreviated timeline, your experiment will not be perfect (e.g., you may not be able to address the exact question you're interested in, your sample will likely not represent the population you want to study, you may not be able to eliminate all confounding variables, etc.), and that's okay.

I am here to do everything in my power to help you pass, in particular through feedback on drafts that you are required to submit throughout the semester before the final paper is due.

Writing Support

Me! I will provide you with some basic tools throughout the course for scientific writing as well as feedback on all of your drafts.

[The Writing Center](#) is a great resource. It offers online resources related to citing sources, understanding and summarizing research articles, writing about statistics, general writing style tips, and more. They also offer tutoring sessions for individualized feedback.

Group work

Though your research project as a whole is a group endeavor, bolded assignments in the Grading Breakdown specifically are to be completed and submitted as a group. In other words, for those assignments there will be just one submission per group, and each group member will receive the same grade for that assignment. You may collaborate for individual assignments (except for the lit review), but the written product must be your own.

Working in a group can be challenging. However, almost all science is conducted collaboratively, and working with peers is excellent practice for any future career. Each group member should contribute equally to the group work. This won't look the same for all groups; for example, some groups may enjoy collaborative writing, whereas other groups may prefer to delegate smaller writing tasks to each person and work independently before coming back together to discuss progress. Any strategy is okay, as long as everyone feels that the workload is evenly distributed.

You will complete two evaluations of the course and group work, one mid-semester and one at the end of the semester. I am the only person who will read these evaluations, and I encourage you to provide honest feedback about the distribution of the work in your group.

Lab participation

You are expected to come to every lab meeting. A large portion of each lab meeting will be devoted to you working with your groupmates. Attendance, participating in any discussions, asking questions during presentations, and communicating effectively with your group will all contribute to your lab participation grade. It is up to your group to choose an effective channel of communication and to use this channel throughout the semester.

5 Attendance & late work

Attendance

I expect you to attend every lab in order to keep up with the demands of the course. Please be respectful of the learning environment and others in it by engaging fully with course activities when attending and silence all devices to avoid disrupting other learners' experiences.

Due dates & late work

Due dates are listed in the [Course schedule](#) on p. 5. Submissions should be ready in

Teams by the time and date listed in the Teams Course Calendar. Submit bolded items as a group.

Because it is necessary to complete each assignment before the next is due, one point will be deducted from an assignment each day it is late (including weekend days). If something comes up, please contact me as soon as possible so that we can find a solution that works for you. Contact me before the due date unless extenuating circumstances prevent you from doing so. Please note, however, that the final IRB and the paper cannot be submitted late.

6 Student responsibilities and resources

Academic Misconduct

Academic dishonesty is the act of taking someone else's work or ideas and presenting them as your own. It can either be deliberate or result from carelessness; you will be held responsible for academic dishonesty regardless of whether you intended to do it. Academic dishonesty can include anything from copying another student's homework to quoting journal articles without referencing them.

If you are unsure whether something falls in the category of academic dishonesty, please ask me for clarification. Academic misconduct is inexcusable and can result in an F for the assignment, an F for the lab section, an F in the class, or even expulsion from the university. Please familiarize yourself with the [university academic misconduct guidelines](#).

Some general guidelines:

- You must give credit to anyone and everyone from whom you took ideas or quotations, including group members.
- Remember that the Introduction and Discussion sections of the paper are to be written individually.
- Using Artificial Intelligence (AI) to assist you in writing is not allowed for this class.

Accommodations

If you have conditions that require accommodations, please contact the Center for Students with Disabilities and we will work together to meet your needs. Please don't hesitate to talk to me about your specific needs if you feel comfortable doing so.

Resources for Students Experiencing Distress

I believe firmly that your, and my, mental health is of paramount importance. These have been particularly challenging times, and stress can manifest in different individuals in quite different ways. If you are unsure how to deal with any mental health issues (whether depression, anxiety, inability to sleep or focus, or any of the myriad ways in which you may be affected), please reach out to me for advice on available services that

can help. The following University statement includes information on student health services:

The University of Connecticut is committed to supporting students in their mental health, their psychological and social well-being, and their connection to their academic experience and overall wellness. The university believes that academic, personal, and professional development can flourish only when each member of our community is assured equitable access to mental health services. The university aims to make access to mental health attainable while fostering a community reflecting equity and diversity and understands that good mental health may lead to personal and professional growth, greater self-awareness, increased social engagement, enhanced academic success, and campus and community involvement.

Students who feel they may benefit from speaking with a mental health professional can find support and resources through the Student Health and Wellness-Mental Health (SHaW-MH) office. Through SHaW-MH, students can make an appointment with a mental health professional and engage in confidential conversations or seek recommendations or referrals for any mental health or psychological concern. We have had much positive feedback from past students about the positive impact visiting SHaW-MH had on their sense of wellbeing and empowerment.

Mental health services are included as part of the university's student health insurance plan and also partially funded through university fees. If you do not have UConn's student health insurance plan, most major insurance plans are also accepted. Students can visit the Student Health and Wellness-Mental Health located in Storrs on the main campus in the Arjona Building, 4th Floor, or (recommended) contact the office at (860) 486-4705, or <https://studenthealth.uconn.edu/> for services or questions.

7 Course Schedule

Our course schedule is on the next page.

bolded items = 1 per group

Date	Topics	In-class group work	Assignments & Due dates
1 Sep 8	Introductions & syllabus Creating a research question	Get to know your group Brainstorm topics	Sep 14: <i>Research idea(s)</i>
2 Sep 15	Literature review APA citations	Finalize topic Start lit search	Sep 21: <i>Lit review</i>
3 Sep 22	Experimental design Writing a research proposal	Discuss design Work on proposal	Sep 28: Research proposal
4 Sep 29	Measurement Intro to Qualtrics SPSS I: Correlations Ethics in research	Finalize design Qualtrics survey Work on IRB	Sep 30: SPSS Exercise 1 Oct 1: <i>CITI Training</i>
5 Oct 6	APA Formatting SPSS II: t-tests	IRB Qualtrics survey	Oct 7: SPSS Exercise 2 Oct 8: IRB draft Oct 10: Qualtrics draft
6 Oct 13	Writing the methods section Pilot experiments	Adjust surveys Methods draft	Oct 13: Final Qualtrics Oct 14: Final IRB Oct 19: Methods draft
7 Oct 20	Writing the introduction SPSS III: One-way ANOVA	Data collection	Oct 20: <i>Course evals</i> Oct 21: SPSS Exercise 3 Oct 26: <i>Intro Draft</i>
8 Oct 27	SPSS IV: factorial ANOVA Downloading & cleaning data Data analysis	Finish data entry Clean & wrangle data Begin data analysis	Oct 28: SPSS Exercise 4
9 Nov 3	Data analysis (& possibly R) Writing the results section	Finish data analysis Make graphs & tables	—
10 Nov 10	Writing the discussion section Making research presentations I	Results section Discussion section	Nov 8: Results draft
11 Nov 17	Writing an abstract Making research presentations II	Abstracts Presentation prep	Nov 18: Abstract Nov 20: <i>Discussion draft</i>
12 Nov 24	Thanksgiving Break	—	—
13 Dec 1	Presentation prep	Presentation prep	Dec 4: Presentation draft
14 Dec 8	Student presentations	Evaluations	Dec 8: Final presentation Dec 9: <i>Course evals</i> Dec 10: <i>Final paper</i>